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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: WalletHub

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

Request for Info on AI



March 14, 2025

From:

Odysseas Papadimitriou
Founder & CEO, WalletHub

Re: National Science Foundation Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

[WalletHub](#) is a personal-finance company that strives to help Americans save money and make better financial decisions. Like many other independent publishers, our business has been devastated by the monopolistic tactics of Google in recent years, and the damage has only intensified lately as the company uses publishers' content to answer user questions without paying them in either monetary terms or traffic back to the publisher. If Google was not a monopoly, publishers would just block any search engines that stole their content without appropriate compensation. In fact, there is [plenty of evidence](#) to suggest that Google is intentionally deteriorating search results to boost advertising revenue.

Along with other small publishers and content creators, we advise the administration to reject the requests by Google and OpenAI to train their models on copyrighted materials without compensating the creator. Giving in to this power grab would kill a generation of small businesses, put thousands of Americans out of work, and prevent new creative enterprises from taking root. In the long run, this would result in an internet filled with average, machine-written content that no one can trust and that gradually devolves like an incestuous family tree. Even more concerning, a few large companies would control what content we consume and what biases this content has.

Now that intellectual property theft at scale is more possible than any time in our history, it is essential that we protect the people that create it: the innovators, the thinkers, the outspoken. As a result, we are advocating for an approach to AI that is fair to everyone, including independent content creators and publishers. We must be compensated for our work, and we cannot allow anticompetitive and illegal practices from big tech companies to censor more Americans or force more small businesses to close their doors.

Main street simply cannot afford to be strangled by their own data, and the country cannot afford to let these tech companies silence inquiries into their activities. The common denominator

between these big tech firms is that they want to use everyone's intellectual property to profit in whatever way they see fit without being accountable and having permission.

The bottom line is that we need to continue protecting intellectual property because that is the only way to ensure people have an incentive to create it. Our nation has excelled at attracting the most creative minds in the world because it is a country where intellectual property is respected and properly rewarded. If we fall for the fear mongering from big tech that argues applying fair use protection to AI "is a matter of national security," it will actually hurt the country's security long term because the world's brightest minds will be incentivized to go elsewhere.

In addition, we must remove the threat of companies holding web traffic or visibility hostage until they get access to a creator's data. Compensation for intellectual property can only be monetary and cannot be tied to traffic or other payment mechanisms that big tech companies can use to force creators to provide consent under the threat of reduced visibility.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best,
Odysseas Papadimitriou

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